

ANUP THAKRE

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Education

Indian Institute of Information Technology, Nagpur

Aug 2023 – May 2027

B.Tech in Computer Science and Engineering (Specialization: Human Computer Interaction)

CGPA: 8.90

Position of Responsibility

Team Lead (2x) | *Smart India Hackathon*

2024 – 2025

- Owned product delivery for a **6-member team** from problem definition to launch under **36-hour sprint conditions**.
- Translated ambiguous problem statements into structured roadmaps – **National Winner 2025, Grand Finalist 2024**.

Lead | *Startup Expo, E-Summit 2025 (E-Cell IIIT Nagpur)*

2025

- Managed onboarding of startup founders and exhibitors, aligning expectations with event goals and timelines.
- Coordinated cross-functional execution across logistics and communication for seamless on-time delivery.

Hospitality Co-Lead | *Tantrafiesta 2025, IIIT Nagpur*

2025

- Led guest experience operations across venue, logistics, and participant touchpoints for the annual technical fest.
- Resolved real-time coordination challenges under pressure with strong **stakeholder communication**.

Honors & Achievements

- Smart India Hackathon 2025 – National Winner** by leading end-to-end product development, defining user-centric solutions, and delivering a scalable system addressing real-world needs.
- Smart India Hackathon 2024 – National Finalist**. Recognized for strong product thinking, problem structuring, and effective execution among top teams nationwide.
- Nation Building Case Study – West Zone Finalist** (Top 10 among 50,000+ participants) for two consecutive years – 2025 and 2026 – by analyzing real-world problems and proposing impactful, user-focused solutions.

Projects

SAKSHAM – Internship Portal (SIH 2025 Winner) | Live | [PRD](#) | [RBAC](#) | [Recommendation System](#)

Nov 2025

- Identified **fragmented internship workflows** as the core user pain point → defined product requirements and designed a unified application and approval system → reduced coordination effort by **40%** across **500+ users**.
- Mapped multi-role coordination challenges through user research → prioritized **role-based access and structured workflows** → enabled secure, scalable interactions across **3+ distinct user roles**.
- Diagnosed low opportunity-match relevance as a key drop-off driver → scoped and shipped a **data-driven recommendation feature** → improved matching relevance and reduced search time by **35%**.

Acadence – Academic Management Platform | Live | [MVP Scoping](#) | [User Feedback](#) | [Multi-role Access](#)

Apr 2026

- Identified **fragmented academic resources** as the primary barrier to student productivity → defined MVP scope covering notes, PYQs, announcements, and collaboration → improved accessibility for **300+ students**.
- Synthesized student feedback revealing inefficient workflows → prioritized and shipped **query systems, study groups, timetable management, and discussion spaces** → increased collaboration efficiency by **45%**.
- Mapped multi-role access as a trust requirement → designed **role-based authentication workflows** for students, faculty, and admins → enabled seamless, secure experiences at scale.

AR/VR Landing Page (UI/UX Design) | Live | [Figma](#) | [Wireframing](#) | [Usability Testing](#) | [Prototyping](#)

Dec 2025

- Diagnosed **low engagement and poor navigation** through usability analysis → redesigned user flows and layouts → reduced navigation friction by **30%**.
- Ran iterative design cycles using **wireframes and high-fidelity prototypes** → validated solutions early with stakeholders → reduced iteration cycles by **25%** and improved interaction clarity.
- Incorporated **user feedback** to refine journeys → improved navigation efficiency and increased user retention by **20%**.

Technical Skills

Product & Design: Stakeholder Management, User Research, Feature Prioritization, Requirement Gathering (PRDs), MVP Scoping, Market Research & Competitive Analysis, UI/UX Design, Wireframing, User Workflows, Design Systems

Technologies: Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL, C++, Next.js, React.js, Node.js, REST APIs, PostgreSQL

AI & Systems Exposure: Generative AI, RAG Systems, Agentic AI, Recommendation Systems, Machine Learning Fundamentals, Scalable Backend Systems

Tools: Jira, Notion, Google Analytics, Figma, Git, GitHub, Postman, Docker, VS Code

Course Work: DSA, OOP, DBMS, Operating Systems, Computer Networks, SDLC, UI/UX Design, HCI